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WAF

VS

RASP

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WAF

Web Application Firewall

Tool(**External** firewall) that protects web servers by filtering and blocking malicious web traffic **before** it reaches the application

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The logo for Runtime Application Self-Protection (RASP) features the word "RASP" in a bold, white, sans-serif font. It is centered within a circular, blurred red gradient that fades into the white background of the slide.

Runtime Application Self-Protection

Technology embedded **inside** the application that protects it during **runtime** by monitoring app behavior

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How They Work (Deployment)

WAF

sits at the network
or cloud edge,
monitoring
inbound/outbound
HTTP(S) traffic



RASP

runs inside the
application, directly
analyzing requests
and behavior in real
time

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Security Approach

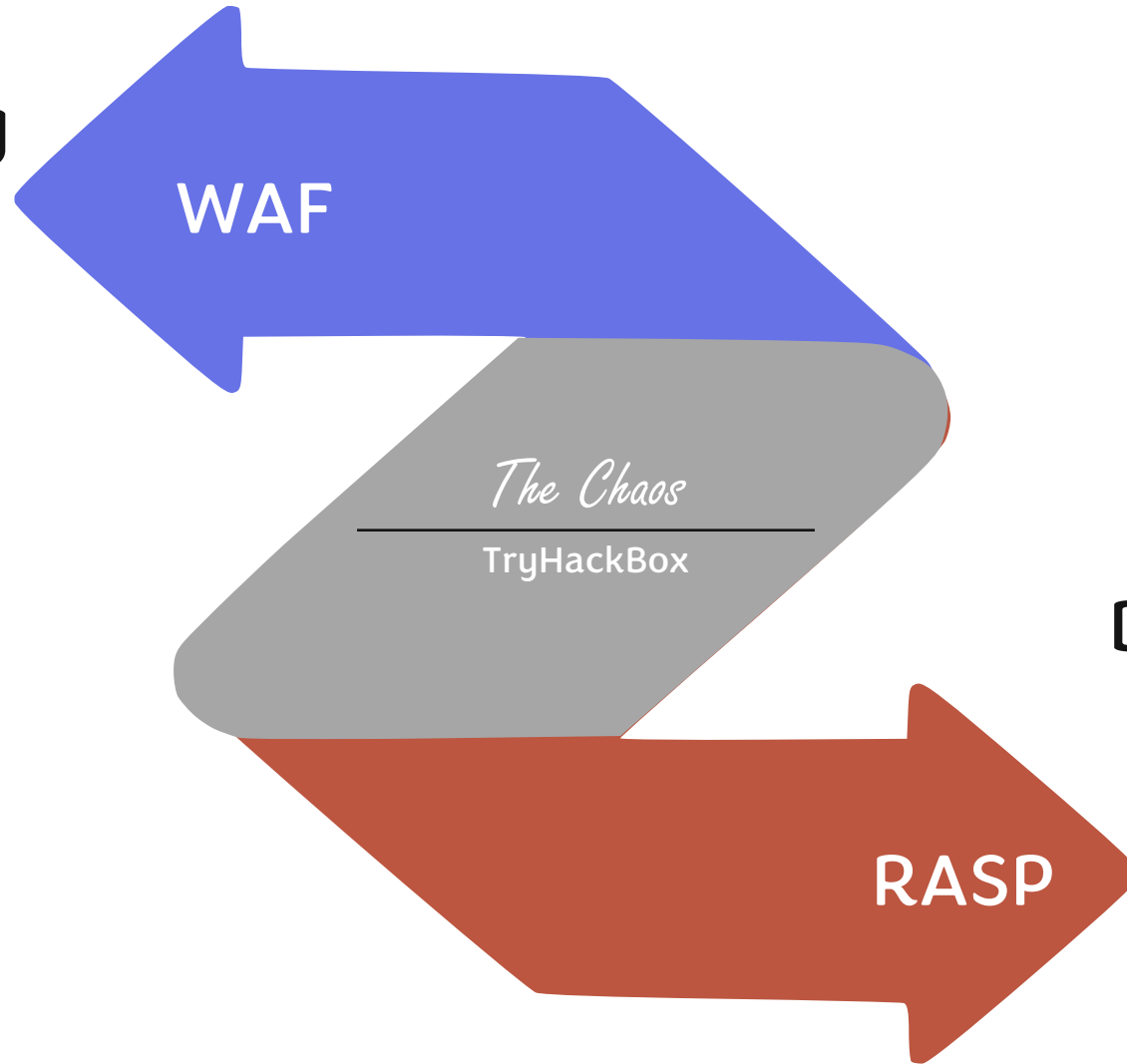
Primarily attack prevention focusing on known threats (e.g., DDoS, SQL injection)

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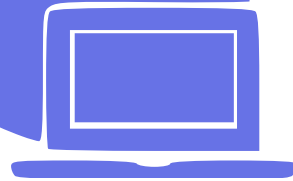
RASP

Detects attacks and vulnerabilities by analyzing app behavior and context during execution



May generate false positives due to pattern/signature-based filtering

WAF



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Detection & Accuracy

False positives are minimized because it monitors actual app behavior in context

RASP



Capabilities & Techniques

WAF

Sets policies for attacks like brute force, XSS, SQLi



RASP

Combines sandboxing, semantic analysis, input tracing, and behavioral analytics

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Performance Impact

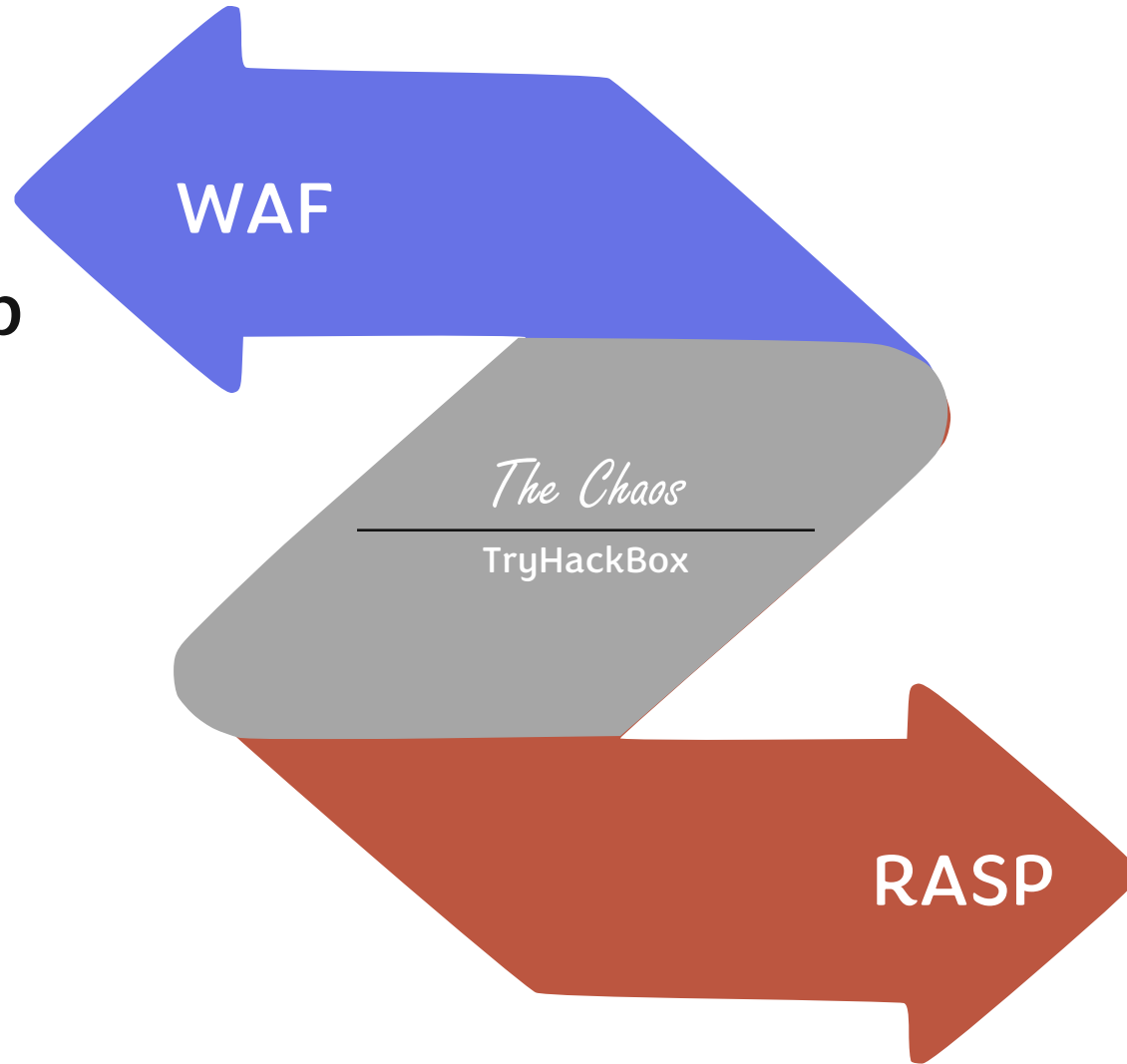
Typically low to moderate impact;
acts outside the app

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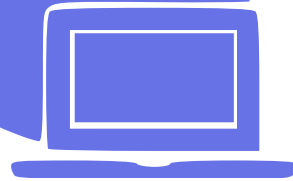
RASP

Minimal overhead
but monitoring can
affect app
performance a bit



Flexible deployment
as standalone or in
hybrid setups; good
for broad perimeter
security

WAF



Use Cases & Deployment Flexibility

Minimal
deployment
overhead; applies
granular defense
from within the app

RASP



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Defense Model

WAF

Multi-layer defense on traffic filtering, blocking malicious HTTP requests before hitting app servers



RASP

Adds defense inside the app by injecting security logic at runtime

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WAF

- 🛡️ Focuses on attack prevention
- 🌐 Filters & blocks malicious HTTP/S traffic
- 🧱 Mitigates DDoS, brute-force, SQLi, XSS
- ⚠️ May generate false positives

⚙️ Works inside the app at runtime

🕵️ Detects attacks and vulnerabilities

🤖 Analyzes real behavior to eliminate false positives

🔍 Uses sandboxing, input tracing & behavioral analysis

RASP

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